

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

A world map with dashed blue lines representing diaspora routes. The lines originate from various points across the globe, including North America, Europe, and Africa, and converge towards a central point in East Asia, specifically China. Other lines radiate from this central point to other parts of the world, including Southeast Asia, the Indian subcontinent, and the Pacific region. The map is overlaid with a yellow horizontal band at the top and a purple horizontal band at the bottom.

DIASPORA - 2

MODULE -55

PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS

1 Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (PBD) is celebrated on **9th January** every year to mark the contribution of **Overseas Indian community** in the development of India.

2 January 9 was chosen as the day to celebrate this occasion since it was on this day in **1915** that **Mahatma Gandhi**, the **greatest Pravasi**, returned to India from South Africa, led India's freedom struggle and changed the lives of Indians forever.

3 PBD conventions are being held every year since 2003.



IMPORTANCE OF PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS

- 1 These conventions provide a platform to the overseas Indian community to engage with the government and people of the land of their ancestors for mutually beneficial activities.
- 2 These conventions are also very useful in networking among the overseas Indian community residing in various parts of the world and enable them to share their experiences in various fields.
- 3 During the event, individuals of exceptional merit are honoured with the prestigious Pravasi Bharatiya Samman Award to appreciate their role in India's growth.
- 4 The event also provides a forum for discussing key issues concerning the Indian diaspora.



PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS OF 2019

- 1 The Government of India termed the 14th Pravasi Bhartiya Divas of 2019 as the largest so far with 8,000 delegates.
- 2 This was especially because it coincided with the Kumbh mela.
- 3 The three-day convention was organized from January 21 to 23 instead of January 9 to allow participants to visit the Kumbh Mela in Allahabad and attend the Republic Day celebrations in Delhi.
- 4 The theme of the convention was 'Role of Indian Diaspora in building new India'.
- 5 The Mauritian Prime Minister was the chief guest for the occasion.
- 6 Prime Minister highlighted India's potential to lead the world in sustainable development.



PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS OF 2019

- 7 PM Modi said that the people living abroad need to connect culturally with homeland and that India is planning a pilgrimage scheme for people living abroad.
- 8 India hopes to provide leadership to the world.
- 9 Prime Minister also urged the Indians living abroad to inspire foreigners to visit the country.
- 10 NRIs are brand ambassadors according to PM Modi and symbols of country's capabilities.



PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS OF 2019

- 11** He remarked that people of Indian origin are in leadership roles in countries such as Mauritius, Portugal and Ireland.
- 12** PM Modi said that India was preparing for a centralized system connected to the passport service for Indians living abroad and simplifying process for issuing visas.
- 13** Indian External Affairs Minister on the occasion remarked that by 2022 India will have the world's largest working population.
- 14** India will be able to export skilled manpower to the world.

- 15** The contribution of Indian diaspora in technical field was exemplary as 16 percent of the start-ups in the Silicon Valley had an Indian co-founder.



REGIONAL PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS (RPBD)

- 1** The OIA Ministry organizes RPBD to allow participation of the Indian diaspora who are unable to attend annual Pravasi Bhartiya Divas in India.
- 2** So far, 7 Regional Pravasi Bhartiya Divas have been held at New York, Singapore, the Hague, Toronto, Sydney and Mauritius.
- 3** The 7th Regional Pravasi Bharatiya Divas (RPBD) Convention was organised by Ministry of OIA in Sydney from 10-12 November 2013.



REGIONAL PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS (RPBD)

- 4 To have interaction and discussion with Indian diaspora to ensure their connectivity with their ancestral motherland.
- 5 The theme of the event was “Connecting for a Shared Future: The Indian Diaspora, India and the Pacific.” Pravasi Bharatiya Samman Awards (PBSA)
- 6 This Award is conferred by the President of India as a part of the Pravasi Bhartiya Convention.



REGIONAL PRAVASI BHARATIYA DIVAS (RPBD)

7 It is the highest honour conferred on overseas Indians or a Non-Resident Indian (NRI), Persons of Indian Origin (PIO) or an organisation or institution established or run by NRI or PIO who has made a significant contribution in one of the following fields:

- i** Better understanding of India
- ii** Support to India's cause and concerns
- iii** Building closer links with India

- iv** Social and Humanitarian causes in India
- v** Welfare of Local Indian community
- vi** Philanthropic and charitable work



KNOW INDIA PROGRAM

1 The objective of the Ministry's Know India Program is to help familiarize Indian diaspora youth, in the age group of 18-26 years, with developments and achievements made by the country and bringing them closer to the land of their ancestors.

2 KIP provides a unique forum for students and young professionals of Indian origin to visit India and to bond closely with contemporary India.



Know India Program

Registrations are currently open for the following Know India Programs.

	Andhra Pradesh 49 KIP - November 20 to December 14, 2018 Last date of registration: October 15, 2018
	Maharashtra and Daman & Diu 58 KIP - December 15 to January 08, 2019 Last date of registration: October 15, 2018
	Gujarat 51 KIP - January 05 to January 29, 2019 Last date of registration: November 15, 2018
	Jharkhand & Bihar 52 KIP - January 16 to February 09, 2019 Last date of registration: November 15, 2018

For additional information & registrations, please visit: <https://kip.gov.in/>

For clarification, email: hoc.newyork@mea.gov.in

STUDY INDIA PROGRAM

1 The Study India Program (SIP) enables overseas Indian youth to undergo short term in an Indian university to familiarise them with the history, heritage, art, culture; to name a few.

2 The focus of this program is on academic orientation and research.

3 This program has immense potential of connecting youth Indian Diaspora with India through the channel of educational institutions.

4 The Study India Program (SIP) was organized from September 25 to 23 October 2012.



OVERSEAS CITIZEN OF INDIA (OCI) CARD SCHEME

- 1** The Overseas Citizen of India (OCI) scheme was launched in August 2005 by amending the Citizenship act of 1955.
- 2** The Scheme was started for engaging PIOs with the land of their ancestors in a mutually beneficial relationship.
- 3** The OCI scheme, operated by the Ministry of Homes Affairs provides for registration as OCI of all Persons of Indian Origin (PIOs) who were citizens of India on or after 26 January 1950 or were eligible to become citizens of India on 26 January, 1950 and who were citizens of other countries, except Bangladesh and Pakistan.

WAYS TO QUALIFY FOR AN OCI CARD

SHOULD BE A CITIZEN OF ANOTHER COUNTRY BUT HAVE TIES WITH INDIA

CHILD
GRAND CHILD

or Great grand child

Of a citizen of another country, but was eligible to become a citizen of India at the time of the commencement of the Constitution;

SPOUSE

of a citizen of India

and have been married for a period of at least two years at time of applying for the OCI Card.

OVERSEAS CITIZEN OF INDIA (OCI) CARD SCHEME

- 4 A registered overseas citizen of India is granted multiple entry, multi-purpose, life-long visa for visiting India.
- 5 However, OCI, is not dual nationality.
- 6 It does not confer any political rights.
- 7 Homeland visits or diaspora tourism is viewed by some scholars as a pre-requisite to contribute constructively to the home country.



SUPPORT BY INDIAN DIASPORA

1 Historically, India had benefited from its diaspora: lobbying for the US-India civil nuclear agreement in 2008 and their remittance inflow.

2 The Indian government continues to engage its diaspora in foreign policy.

Two incidents of recent times displayed the strength and support of the diaspora on domestic issues, which were:

1. Floods in Kerala
2. Pulwama attack.



SUPPORT BY INDIAN DIASPORA

1. KERALA FLOODS

- 1 In a globalized world, the international dimensions of disaster response and recovery and the significant policy role played by the diaspora can be critical.
- 2 Indian diaspora played a crucial role in rehabilitation of Kerala floods.
- 3 An Indian minister in the centre announced that Indian diaspora residing in China's Shanghai has contributed Rs 32.13 lakh to the Chief Minister's distress relief fund for Kerala floods.



SUPPORT BY INDIAN DIASPORA

2. PULWAMA ATTACK

1 In response to the Pulwama attack, the Indian community in UAE gathered in large numbers at the Indian embassy in Abu Dhabi to express sympathy and solidarity with the families of CRPF men killed in the terrorist strike.

2 In Australia as well, members of the Indian diaspora gathered outside the Victorian Parliament to condemn the attacks.



DIASPORA IN CONTEMPORARY TIMES

- 1 The communication and transportation revolution and the global reach of media are creating a major change in the relationship between the diasporas and the country of their origin.
- 2 India must follow a robust and flexible policy in order to leverage the strengths of diaspora and minimise the possibility of any negative fallout
- 3 The nature of engagement with the diaspora has changed according to the needs of time.



DIASPORA IN CONTEMPORARY TIMES

- 4 Because of extraordinary diversity and geographical spread, the policy of engagement has to be made to suit every segment of the diaspora.
- 5 The approach towards the workers in the Gulf is primarily welfare oriented and remittance centric.
- 6 Engagement with the developed world has to be multifaceted and aimed at making India a knowledge power.



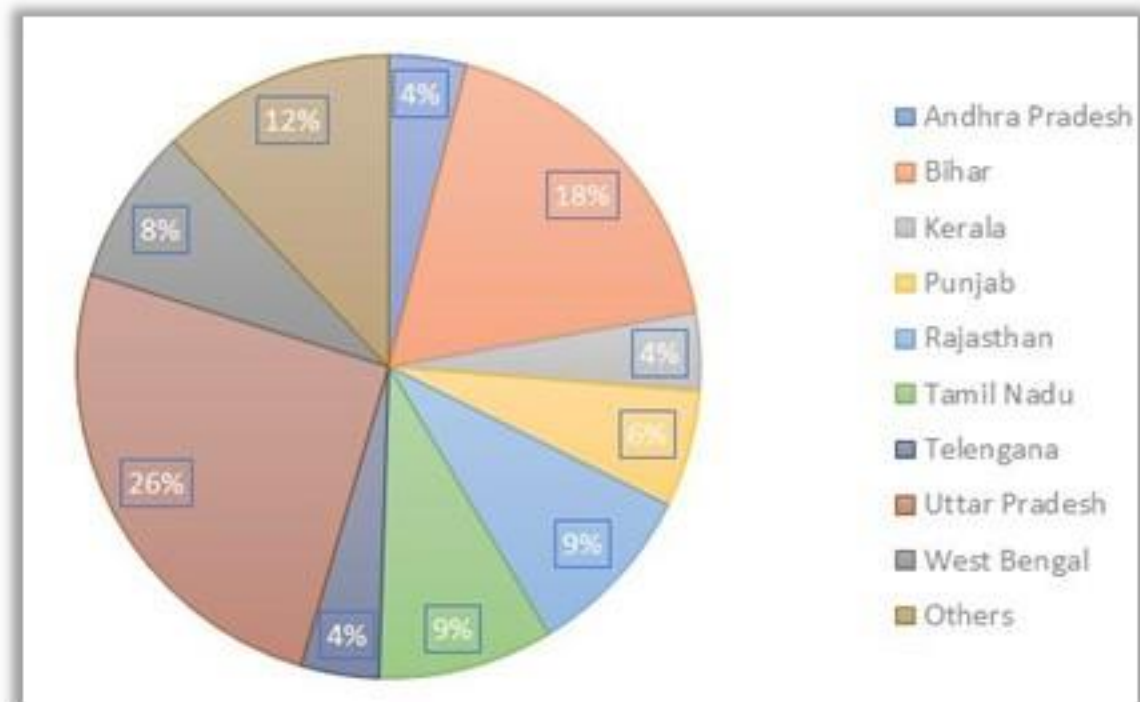
CHALLENGES IN THE JOURNEY

There are several challenges which hinder our process of harnessing the energy of the diaspora to the maximum.

1 Dual citizenship is one of the important demands of the diaspora. Presently, once they opt to take foreign citizenship, they forfeit their Indian citizenship.

2 The support of the diaspora is neither automatic nor continuous and their interest need not be India's priorities.

3 For example, India faced problems due to foreign support and funding for the Khalistani movement.



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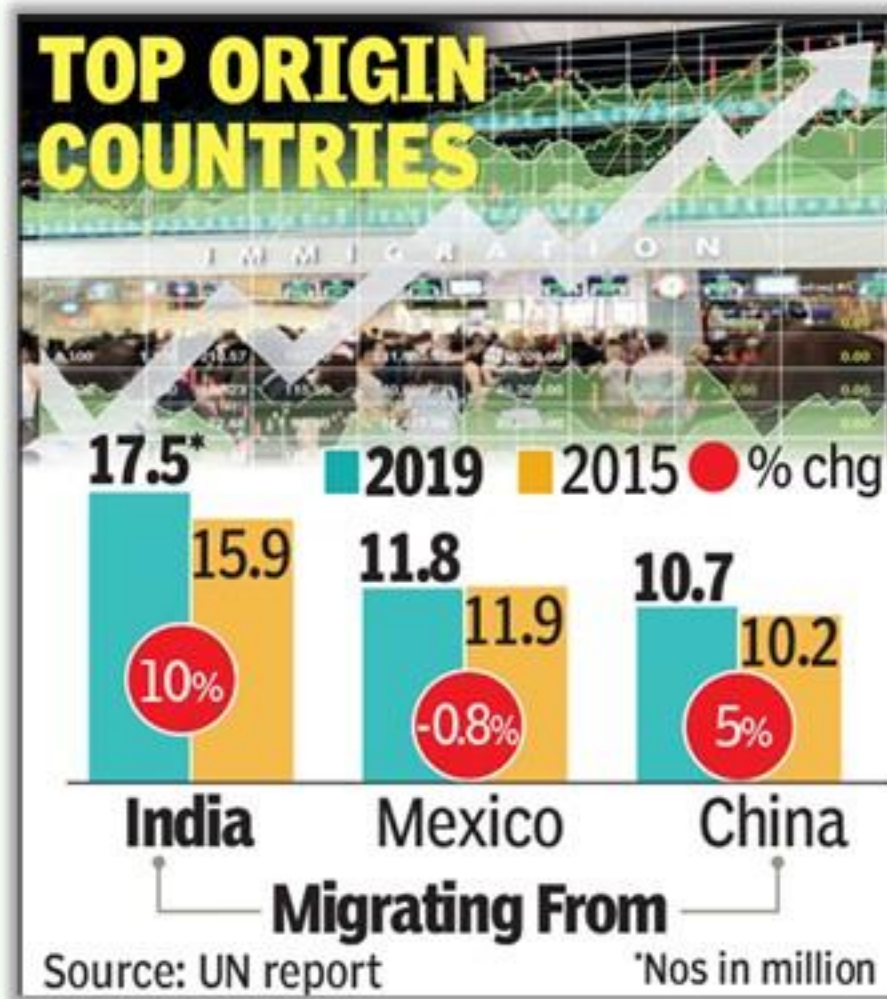
4 The E-migrate system and the Minimum Referral Wages policy have been detrimental to India as companies now find it easier to get labour from Bangladesh and Pakistan.

5 There are other problems such as the wealthier diaspora from the US, Canada and the UK wanting dual citizenship and voting rights.



DIASPORA: AN INGREDIENT FOR FUTURE GROWTH

- 1 At the recent discussions, Prime Minister Modi has reinstated faith in the potential of Indian Diaspora in helping India achieve the status of a global power.
- 2 A strong diaspora reflects India's strength and the capability of its human resources in shaping the world.
- 3 The time is opportune for India to convert the 'Brain Drain' to 'Brain Gain' and help India harness and capitalise upon the vibrant diaspora for its development and help India become 'AtmaNirbhar'



DIASPORA: AN INGREDIENT FOR FUTURE GROWTH

4 India's recent initiatives with regards to relaxation of visa regulations, allocating a day for practicing and celebrating Yoga, start-up programs calling NRIs and PIOs, has helped create a new image for India in the worlds.

5 The intellectual and financial capital of the untapped force is being utilised. This diaspora can play a major role in furthering India's bond with the world.

6 The vision of new India has resonated with the Indian diaspora which is not defined by a region, class or caste but India as a unified whole.



WE EXPRESS OUR
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